



Media, Who Owns It?

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Spelling & Recall • Multiple Choice • Prior Knowledge • Open / Creative • Intentional Motor

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Think about what it once meant to own your favorite album. A vinyl record, CASSETTE, or CD was a physical object you could hold, lend to someone, sell, lose, scratch, or keep on a shelf for decades; even the MP3 era usually meant downloading an actual file onto a device you controlled. Today, music is DOMINATED (controlled, ruled) by streaming, where a SUBSCRIPTION can unlock millions of songs without giving you individual copies of them. In the United States, streaming generated about \$9.5 billion in recorded-music revenue in 2025, compared with about \$1.4 billion from physical formats, but physical music has not completely VANISHED, and vinyl revenue actually grew past \$1 billion that same year. The big change is a shift from POSSESSION toward ACCESS (admission, entry): instead of building a collection one object at a time, we increasingly enter enormous libraries assembled and managed by someone somewhere else.

Let's spell: POSSESSION STREAMING PHYSICAL BUILDING

During the MP3 era, music was usually downloaded as a _____. FILE

Today, music is _____ by streaming. DOMINATED

A _____ can unlock millions of songs without giving you individual copies. SUBSCRIPTION

The bigger change described is a shift from possession toward _____. ACCESS

Physical music has not completely _____. VANISHED

Name one physical music format mentioned. VINYL RECORD, CASSETTE, CD

Give me a synonym for dominated mentioned in the passage. CONTROLLED, RULED

Give me a synonym for access mentioned in the passage. ADMISSION, ENTRY

What object is commonly used to play a vinyl record? TURNTABLE

What major music streaming service is known for its green circular logo? SPOTIFY

If you could own a physical copy of one album, which would you choose?

Does having access to something feel different to you than possessing it?

Would you rather have a shelf of your favorite albums or immediate access to almost anything you want to hear? Why?

What is one thing a physical music collection can do that a streaming library cannot?



Movies have followed an even sharper version of this transition. U.S. consumers spent about \$870 million on physical home-video products in 2025, while subscription movie-and-TV streaming generated roughly \$57.5 billion, making the shelf of DVDs and BLU-RAYs a much smaller part of home entertainment than it once was. A disc and a stream can show you the same movie, but they do not give you the same kind of control: a lawfully owned physical copy can generally be resold or otherwise transferred under U.S. copyright law, while a streaming title remains DEPENDENT (conditional, reliant) on a service continuing to offer it. Even a digital purchase can sit somewhere between those worlds; Apple's current terms say purchased content will generally remain available, but acknowledge that it may later become unavailable if Apple loses the right to distribute it and therefore encourage customers to download and back up purchases. "Owning media" has become a more CONVOLUTED (complicated, tangled) experience than it used to be.

Let's spell: SMALLER DISTRIBUTE PURCHASE DOWNLOAD

What other type of media has followed this sharp transition to streaming? MOVIES

A disc and a stream do not provide the same kind of _____. CONTROL

Streaming titles remain _____ on a service continuing to offer it. DEPENDENT

What company's current terms acknowledge your purchase may later be unavailable? APPLE

"Owning media" has become a more _____ experience than it used to be. CONVOLUTED

Name one physical movie format mentioned in the passage. DVD, BLU-RAY

Give me a synonym for dependent mentioned in the passage. CONDITIONAL, RELIANT

Give me a synonym for convoluted mentioned in the passage. COMPLICATED, TANGLED

What physical video format was widely used before DVD? VHS

Give me one of the three colors apples (the fruit) most commonly come in? RED, GREEN, YELLOW

If the price were identical, would you choose a physical movie or a digital purchase? Why?

Would you still consider something a purchase if access to it could someday disappear?

If a movie disappeared from every streaming service but you owned the disc, would that change how valuable the disc felt?



That difference becomes stranger when the media itself can change around you. NETFLIX openly described PERSONALIZING the artwork used to represent the same movie or series, selecting from different images based on what they believe may appeal to a particular viewer. The film does not change, but two people can enter it through different DIGITAL (electronic, virtual) covers without ever realizing they were shown something entirely different. A more dramatic example occurred in 2009, when AMAZON removed unauthorized Kindle editions of GEORGE ORWELL's *1984* and *Animal Farm* from customers' devices because the third-party seller didn't have the necessary rights; customers were refunded, Amazon changed its policy, and Jeff Bezos publicly criticized (condemn, denounce) the company's handling of the situation. That was a COPYRIGHT dispute, not a censorship campaign, but it demonstrated something a PAPERBACK never could: under certain digital systems, the company providing access may retain technical power over a copy even after someone believes they have bought it.

Let's spell: BELIEVE ARTWORK COPYRIGHT TECHNICAL

What company described personalizing their artwork for viewers? NETFLIX

Two viewers can be shown different _____ covers without realizing it. DIGITAL

Who did we mention was the author of *1984* and *Animal Farm*? GEORGE ORWELL

These copies were removed because the third-party seller did not have the necessary _____. RIGHTS

This copyright dispute demonstrated something a _____ could never. PAPERBACK

Give me a synonym for digital mentioned in the passage. ELECTRONIC, VIRTUAL

Name one George Orwell book mentioned in the passage. 1984, ANIMAL FARM

Give me a synonym for criticized mentioned in the passage. CONDEMN, DENOUNCE

What is the name of Jeff Bezos space company? BLUE ORIGIN

Amazon is named after the Amazon River, what continent is the river on? SOUTH AMERICA

If Netflix was altering your covers to be different than someone else's, would you want to know?

If you were given the funds of Jeff Bezos, what might you do with them?

Would Amazon's ability to remove these book titles change your thoughts about purchasing digital copies? Why or why not?



Books make the story even less predictable, because physical publishing is nowhere near dead. Print formats still produced 76.3% of U.S. trade-publishing REVENUE (earnings, income) in 2025, meaning readers continue to choose physical books even as e-books, audiobooks, and massive digital libraries exist beside them. Yet DIGITIZATION can create some strange collisions between the physical and digital worlds: in a 2025 federal court case, evidence showed that ANTHROPIC purchased millions of print books, removed their bindings, cut the pages, scanned them into searchable digital files, and discarded the paper copies as part of building an internal research library. That does not mean books must be destroyed to digitize them; the Library of Congress uses specialized equipment, book cradles, and careful handling specifically to scan materials while minimizing damage to the originals. Whoever is deciding to digitize can therefore choose to destroy a physical copy through one method or help PRESERVE (protect, save) a fragile physical collection through an alternative method.

Let's spell: RESEARCH MILLIONS FEDERAL FRAGILE

Books make the story of digitization even less _____. PREDICTABLE

Print formats still produced 76.3% of U.S. trade-publishing _____ in 2025. REVENUE

Who purchased millions of print books and discarded them after being scanned? ANTHROPIC

The Library of _____ uses specialized methods to minimize damage to books. CONGRESS

You can choose to destroy a copy or help _____ a fragile physical collection. PRESERVE

Give me a synonym for revenue mentioned in the passage. EARNINGS, INCOME

Name one digital book format mentioned in the passage. EBOOK, AUDIOBOOK

Give me a synonym for preserve mentioned in the passage. PROTECT, SAVE

What popular AI assistant is created by Anthropic? CLAUDE

What branch of the U.S. government does Congress belong to? LEGISLATIVE

What types of books do you think are a priority to preserve?

Would you be comfortable destroying one physical copy if doing so helped create a useful digital copy?

If you had to preserve a book for the next hundred years, would you trust paper, digital storage, both, or something else entirely? Why?

Intentional Motor Activity: Shelf to Player

Using several lightweight, non-breakable pieces of physical media such as books, empty DVD cases, or CD cases, place the items randomly across a table, shelf, or nearby surface. Beginning beside the collection, choose one item at a time, pick it up using both hands, carry it to a designated stacking area, and place it down carefully. Continue selecting and stacking items until the full collection has been built into one stable stack.

For motor planning, break the movement into a simple sequence:

CHOOSE → REACH → GRASP → CARRY → PLACE / STACK

For an added challenge, vary the size or shape of the media so your athlete has to decide where each item should be placed to keep the stack stable... or watch it tumble!

Primary focus: grasp and release, bilateral coordination, controlled carrying, object placement, sequencing, and spatial awareness.



With all these considerations, this doesn't make physical media safer or digital media worse. Records warp, tapes deteriorate, discs scratch, books burn, and a rare physical object can disappear forever if its few surviving copies are destroyed (demolish, wreck). Digital files can be duplicated across locations, making it possible to preserve and access the same work without relying on a single physical copy. CONVENIENCE changes where the weak point sits: instead of depending only on the object in your possession, digital access may also depend on accounts, compatible technology, licensing, companies, and servers you do not control. The strange part is that this trade can feel almost invisible because new systems are often dramatically easier to use than old ones. If a movie appears instantly when you press play, does it matter whether you own the copy underneath that button? Maybe the real question is how much PERMANENCE (continuity, durability) we are willing to exchange for convenience, and whether we care when that exchange happens.

Let's spell: MEDIA LOCATION EXCHANGE QUESTION

These considerations don't make physical media _____ or digital media worse. SAFER

A rare physical object can disappear forever if its few surviving copies are _____. DESTROYED

Duplicating digital files means preservation does not have to depend on a single physical _____. COPY

According to the passage, new systems are often dramatically _____ to use than old ones.

EASIER

Maybe the real question is how much _____ we are willing to exchange for convenience.

PERMANENCE

Name one type of physical media mentioned that can become damaged or deteriorate. RECORDS, TAPES, DISCS, BOOKS

Give me a synonym for destroyed mentioned in the passage. DEMOLISH, WRECK

Give me a synonym for permanence mentioned in the passage. CONTINUITY, DURABILITY

What commonly protects access to a personal online account? PASSWORD

What word describes remote internet-based storage? CLOUD

Which tradeoff from this lesson feels more important to you personally: convenience or permanence? Why?

After learning about physical copies, digital purchases, streaming, and licensing, has your definition of ownership changed? How so ?

What part of physical ownership would you miss the most if everything became digital?

SOURCES

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